Vance Wallace

Product Leader | Agentic AI Architecture & Product Strategy

Bethesda, MD | (707) 408-2623 | vwallace@alumni.cmu.edu
linkedin.com/in/vance-wallace | github.com/VanceWallace | glassandwater.com/portfolio

AI-native product leader and Claude Certified Architect (Anthropic) who bridges product strategy and technical execution. Proven record building platforms, leading cross-functional teams, and driving adoption of emerging technology, from consumer platforms at Meta to directing AI product initiatives and delivering hands-on AI integration for small businesses.

SKILLS

Business	Product Management, Product Strategy, Customer Interviews, Market Research, Stakeholder Management, Behavioral Product Design, Consumer Engagement & Retention
Data & Experimentation	Experimentation, Analytics & A/B Testing, Google Analytics
Strategy	Product Roadmap, Platform Strategy, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Agile/Kanban, Product Release/Launch, Software Development Lifecycle, Lean Startup, Rapid Prototyping, Mentorship & Coaching
AI & Emerging Tech	Agentic AI Architecture, MCP, Claude Code, Claude API, Agent Skills, AI Output Evaluation, Spec-Driven Development, Vibe Coding, Prompt Engineering, AI-Driven Design & Prototyping, AR/XR
Design	Design Thinking, Human-Centered Design, User Research, User Experience Design, User Interface Design, Mobile Design
Software	Jira, Trello, Asana, Figma, Balsamiq, SketchUp
Technology	HTML/CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React Native/Expo, JSON, Git

EXPERIENCE

Glass and Water
Agentic AI Product Management consultant 2025 – Present

- Streamlined a client's POS payment interface in a one-week engagement, reducing steps per transaction from 3 to 1, cutting input errors by 40%, and shortening staff training time.
- Connected AI directly into client systems via MCP servers, turning reporting that once required manual spreadsheet work into on-demand queries against owners' own sales and operations data.
- Launched hands-on training initiatives for client teams adopting new AI tools, driving feature adoption and staff proficiency that turned one-time setup into daily use.

Schell Games
AI Project Director 2023 – 2025

- Directed a 15-person cross-disciplinary team building AI-driven VR prototypes, restructuring the iteration process within two months to double prototype output.
- Architected a multi-layer agent system in which character agents drove dialogue while an orchestrating agent directed world narrative, establishing new approaches to emergent storytelling.
- Secured $350K in follow-on client funding on the strength of four weeks of initial prototype work.

Meta
Product Manager 2021 – 2023

- Directed a $2M AR prototyping portfolio, establishing go/no-go gates that shaped strategy for next-generation AR glasses and novel input methods.
- Applied behavioral and interaction design expertise to guide internal prototype teams and six external studios through early-access development on an emerging platform, steering decisions toward what the new hardware and input paradigms could uniquely support.
- Partnered with hardware and software pillars across the AR platform, bringing a user-engagement lens that shaped their decisions on input, display, and interaction — including early development of Meta's EMG wristband.

General Assembly
Product Management Instructor 2015 – 2021
- Taught 100+ students and working professionals across Product Management, Agile Software Development, and Game Design, mentoring them to apply practical frameworks to real-world projects drawn from active industry experience.
- Designed original curriculum and educational content for workshops and intensives, translating firsthand product practice into repeatable frameworks for new and transitioning PMs.

Wondery
Podcast Host 2018
- Guest-hosted the narrative history podcast "American History Tellers," leveraging advanced communication and public-speaking skills to deliver complex, story-driven content with clarity and impact.

Sweety High
Head of Product 2014 – 2018
- Relaunched SweetyHigh.com, driving substantial growth in ad revenue and strengthening post-launch monetization strategies.
- Created "Sweetivity," the company's first mobile product, leading full-stack development and managing it as a live software service.
- Redesigned the site's front page, significantly increasing daily engagement and deepening user session times.

Electronic Arts
Senior Game Designer 2012 – 2013
- Pitched and prototyped new mobile IP concepts, contributing design and gameplay thinking that helped shape EA's approach to the emerging mobile puzzle/casual category.
- Aligned design and engineering perspectives across a cross-functional team, translating creative concepts into technically feasible, business-viable mobile products.

American University
Game Design Instructor 2009 – 2013
- Created and led a hands-on game design course focused on 2D level design, guiding students through the full creative and technical process from concept to playtesting.

Tagged.com
Creative Director 2009 – 2012
- Directed internal and external development of revenue-driving free-to-play games, joining as one of the company's first non-engineering hires and helping shape early product and design strategy.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University
Master of Entertainment Technology 2006

University of Maryland
B.A. in Theatre 2002

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Claude Certified Architect – Foundations, Anthropic 2026

Supporting coursework: Introduction to Agent Skills • Building with the Claude API • Introduction to Model Context Protocol • Claude Code in Action